



A MAGICWORKS PLAYBOOK

The AI-Native Website Spec Sheet

What to demand from your next website build

Built for Indian businesses • 2026 edition

MagicWorks

MagicWorks IT Solutions Pvt. Ltd. • An AI-first digital marketing agency • Pune

Evolving with Purpose.

About this spec sheet

Who it is for: founders, marketing heads, and product leaders about to commission a new website or a relaunch, who want to brief a developer well and judge the result with confidence.

What you will get: a clear, vendor-neutral specification of what a modern business website must do, organised so you can lift it straight into a brief or an RFP, plus a one-page checklist and the red flags to avoid.

How to use it: read Parts 1 and 2 to understand the shift, then work through the specification in Part 3 section by section and mark what matters for you. Hand the checklist to whoever builds your site.

One promise up front: this is written to arm you, not to sell you a build. Brief any competent team with it and you will get a better website. And if you would like us to build it, that offer stands at the end.

We build the way we advise. This spec is the same standard we hold our own work to.

Executive summary: the essentials

If you read nothing else, read this.

1. **A website is a revenue tool, not a brochure.** Brief it around an outcome, leads, bookings, or sales, not around a page count.
2. **Fast, accessible, and findable beats flashy.** Performance and being found, in search and inside AI answers, matter far more than animation.
3. **AI-native means built smart and built to be found, not gimmicks.** Be clear about which AI features actually earn their place.
4. **You must own everything.** Your domain, content, code, and data. No lock-in, ever.
5. **Cheap is expensive.** The lowest quote usually costs more once you count the leads it loses and the rebuild it forces.

Key takeaway: Your website's real job is to turn attention into qualified conversations. Every decision in this spec serves that.

Part 1: Why your next website is different now

The short version: your website now does the early selling, before anyone talks to you. Buyers research, compare, and largely decide on their own. A slow, thin, or hard-to-find site quietly loses you business every day, whether or not you ever see it happen.

Two shifts make this moment different. First, a growing share of buyers arrive through AI answers, so your site must be built to be found and quoted by answer engines, not only to rank in a list of links. Second, a wave of AI website builders has made cheap, fast sites easy to produce. That is

genuinely useful for the simplest needs, but it has widened the gap for any business whose site must actually convert and be found.

The bar has moved. Speed, clarity, trust, and findability are now table stakes. The good news is that meeting that bar is mostly a matter of insisting on the right things, which is exactly what this spec helps you do.

Key takeaway: Brief your website around turning attention into qualified conversations, and judge every feature against that.

Part 2: What "AI-native" actually means

An AI-native website is one built using AI to move faster, built to work with AI search, and, where it genuinely helps, using AI in the experience itself. It is not a chatbot bolted on for show.

It helps to separate two senses of the term. There is AI in the build, a modern stack and tooling that let a good team work faster and cleaner. And there is AI in the experience, features a visitor actually touches, like an assistant that answers questions instantly or smarter on-site search. Be clear which you are paying for, and why.

An honest note: most "AI features" on websites are decoration. The valuable ones solve a real visitor problem, answering a question at once, or helping someone find the right thing faster. Demand the value, not the buzzword.

Key takeaway: AI-native is a means to clarity, speed, and findability. It is not a feature checklist to show off.

Part 3: The specification

Work through this with whoever will build your site. Each section is something to demand and check.

A. Strategy and outcomes

- Define the single primary goal of the site, and the secondary ones.
- Name the audience and the few actions you want them to take.
- Agree the metrics you will judge success by before any design starts.
- Write the content first and design around it. Copy that answers real questions is the asset; design serves it.

B. Performance and technical foundation

- Fast on a mid-range phone on a normal Indian mobile network, not just on the developer's laptop.
- Meets Core Web Vitals, with a performance target you agree up front.
- Reliable, scalable hosting with HTTPS, an SSL certificate, and regular backups.
- Mobile-first and responsive, tested on real devices.

- Clean, semantic, crawlable HTML, with content that is not trapped behind scripts an engine cannot read.

C. Findability: SEO, AEO, and AI search readiness

- Built to rank in search and to be cited inside AI answers.
- Proper title tags, meta descriptions, heading structure, and a logical URL structure.
- Structured data for your organisation, services, articles, and FAQs.
- An XML sitemap, sensible internal links, and a redirect plan for any old URLs so you keep your existing rankings.
- Answer-first content and genuine FAQs, so answer engines can quote you.

Key takeaway: If a search engine cannot cleanly read your site, an AI answer engine cannot either. Findability is a build requirement, not an afterthought.

D. Conversion

- Clear, specific calls to action on every important page.
- Short, working forms that send leads where you can act on them, with a confirmation to the visitor.
- Trust signals: real proof, client names where permitted, reviews, and credentials.
- Analytics and conversion tracking live from day one. You cannot improve what you do not measure.
- A fast, obvious path to contact you.

E. AI features that earn their place

- Worth it when they solve a real problem: an assistant that answers visitor questions and captures leads around the clock, smarter on-site search, or genuinely helpful personalisation.
- Be wary of: AI features with no clear visitor benefit, anything that slows the site, or "AI" used only as a label.
- Ask the builder to justify each AI feature by the specific visitor problem it solves.

F. Content and the CMS

- A content management system your team can actually use to edit pages, posts, and job openings without a developer.
- A sensible content model, so your blog, careers, and case studies are structured, not hard-coded.
- Clear ownership and a simple process for who updates what.

G. Design, brand, and accessibility

- On-brand, consistent, and clear. Design serves the message, not the other way round.
- Accessible: good contrast, keyboard navigation, and alt text. Accessible sites are also more findable.
- A consistent component and style system, so the site stays coherent as it grows.

H. Compliance and trust

- A privacy policy, terms, and a cookie-consent mechanism, reflecting India's DPDP Act 2023.
- Capture only the data you need, and store it responsibly.
- Name a contact for data and grievances, as the DPDP Act expects.

Key takeaway: Compliance is part of trust. Buyers and engines both reward a site that handles data responsibly.

I. The build process and your RFP

- A written scope, timeline, and milestones.
- Clarity on who owns the domain, the code, the content, and the accounts. The answer should be you, fully.
- A staging site for review, and proper testing before launch.
- A redirect plan, so you keep your search equity through the move.
- Training and documentation at handover.
- A maintenance and support plan after launch. A website is a living asset, not a one-time project.

Part 4: Red flags and honest cautions

- **The suspiciously cheap quote.** The hidden cost arrives later, as lost leads and a rebuild.
- **Vague "we will do SEO."** Ask exactly what, and how it will be measured.
- **Lock-in.** If you cannot take your domain, content, or code elsewhere, walk away.
- **No analytics or tracking.** You will be flying blind on what works.
- **Guaranteed rankings or guaranteed AI citations.** No one can promise these honestly.
- **Endless animation and slow load.** Flash that quietly costs you conversions.

Part 5: How to choose a partner

- Ask to see real sites they have built, and the results those drove.
- Ask how they approach speed, findability, and AI search specifically.
- Ask exactly what you will own, and how handover works.
- Ask how they measure success after launch.
- Ask who maintains the site, and at what cost.

Key takeaway: A good partner arms you with clear answers and clear ownership. Vagueness is the warning sign.

Part 6: Frequently asked questions

Do I need an expensive custom site, or is a template fine?

It depends on your goal. A template can be fine for the simplest needs, but a business that must convert and rank usually outgrows one quickly. Match the build to the outcome, not to the cheapest option.

Are AI website builders good enough?

For the simplest needs, sometimes. For a site that must convert, rank, and be found in AI answers, they usually fall short on findability, conversion, and ownership. Use this spec to judge any option honestly.

WordPress or a modern framework?

Both can be excellent. What matters is speed, clean code, a CMS your team can use, and that you own it. Pick the fit, not the fashion.

How long should a build take?

A serious business site typically takes several weeks to a few months. Be wary of both "ready in a day" and timelines that never end.

How do I keep my Google rankings when I relaunch?

With a proper redirect plan that maps every old URL to its new home. Never launch a relaunch without one.

What happens after launch?

A good site needs maintenance, fresh content, and measurement. Budget for an ongoing plan, not just the build.

Part 7: How MagicWorks can help

We are an AI-first digital marketing agency in Pune, and we have spent seventeen years building and growing websites for Indian businesses.

Web Development. From 2026 our default build is AI-native: a modern framework, an AI-ready backend, and a headless CMS your team can actually run, with WordPress on request. Built fast, built to convert, and built to be found in search and in AI answers.

Because we also do the marketing, your site is briefed around outcomes, not just looks. The people who will fill your funnel help shape the thing that feeds it.

We do not promise guaranteed rankings. We promise a site you own, that performs, and that is built to the standard set out in this spec.

The next step: book a thirty-minute discovery call. Bring this checklist, and we will tell you honestly what your build needs. No obligation.

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Appendix: the one-page website spec checklist

Strategy

- ☐ Single primary goal and success metrics agreed
- ☐ Audience and key actions defined
- ☐ Content written first

Performance and technical

- ☐ Fast on mid-range mobile; Core Web Vitals met
- ☐ HTTPS, SSL, backups, reliable hosting
- ☐ Clean, crawlable, semantic HTML

Findability

- ☐ Titles, metas, headings, and URL structure
- ☐ Schema for organisation, services, articles, FAQs
- ☐ XML sitemap, internal links, and a redirect map
- ☐ Answer-first content and genuine FAQs

Conversion

- ☐ Clear calls to action on every key page
- ☐ Working forms routed to where you act on leads
- ☐ Trust signals and real proof
- ☐ Analytics and conversion tracking live

AI and content

- ☐ Each AI feature justified by a visitor problem
- ☐ A CMS your team can actually use
- ☐ A sensible content model and clear ownership

Compliance and ownership

- ☐ Privacy, terms, and cookie consent (DPDP Act 2023)
- ☐ You own the domain, code, content, and accounts
- ☐ Staging, testing, training, and a maintenance plan

This spec sheet is provided for general guidance. Technology and best practice evolve; the principles are durable. For advice tailored to your build, speak with our team.

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